

VERIFICATION INFRASTRUCTURE FOR THE SOCIAL SECTOR

We make social outcomes auditable.

Saudi Arabia's non-profit sector grew roughly ninefold in under a decade. Almost none of it can prove what it achieved. We are building the layer that can.

Aimen Rafiq · Founder
100% women-led · Pakistan & Saudi Arabia
jointorchbearer.com

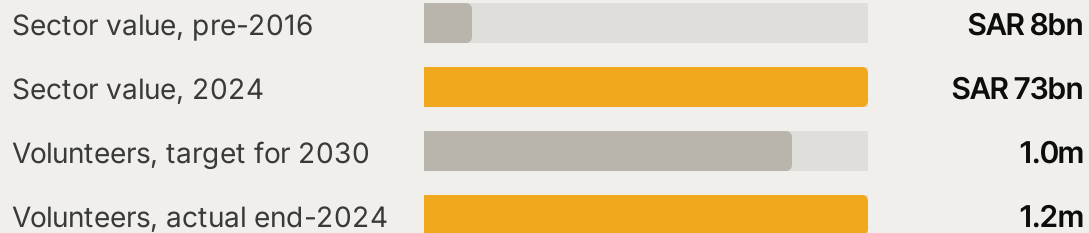
COMPANY PURPOSE

**Torchbearer designs, delivers and
verifies social and environmental
programmes — and produces evidence
that survives an audit.**

Most organisations in this sector can do the first two. The third is the scarce one, it is the one regulators and disclosure regimes are now converging on, and it is where we have built our entire method.

THE PROBLEM

A sector scaled ninefold. Its measurement did not.



Sources: National Center for Non-Profit Sector; Saudi Press Agency; Vision 2030. Bars scaled within each pair.

Saudi Arabia's third sector hit its 2030 volunteering target six years early and multiplied its economic value by roughly nine.

Every headline figure is an **input**. Riyals committed. Organisations registered. Volunteers signed up.

Not one of them says what changed for anybody. The regulator has now shifted its own strategy from growing the sector to professionalising it — governance, standards, measurable impact.

WHY NOW

Four things became true at the same time.

2025

CMA made disclosure binding for green and sustainability-linked debt issuers, after voluntary guidelines in 2019 and a Tadawul framework in 2021

94

Listed companies published sustainability reports in 2024 — around 65% of the top 100 by revenue, largely voluntarily

278Mt

Annual CO₂ reduction committed under the Saudi Green Initiative by 2030, with net zero by 2060

5%

Vision 2030 target for the third sector's share of GDP, against 1.55% today

Environmental commitments already have numbers attached. Social commitments do not. As ISSB-aligned standards move through SOCPA and assurance approaches, every organisation delivering social programmes on behalf of a Saudi corporate is about to be asked a question it cannot currently answer.

THE INSIGHT WE ARE BETTING ON

Carbon has a unit.
Social has none — so it
gets reported in proxies.

PILLAR	COMMON UNIT	REPORTED AS
Environmental	tCO ₂ e	An outcome
Governance	Structural facts	Verifiable
Social	None	Training hours. People reached.

Training hours are an input. A policy is an intention. "People reached" is an activity wearing the costume of an outcome.

And the fix cannot be applied later. **A programme that ran for three years without a baseline cannot be given one in year four.**

Which means this is a **delivery** problem, not a reporting problem. That is the whole thesis.

WHAT WE ARE BUILDING

Torchbearer **Verify**

A tech-enabled platform that takes a social programme from design to audit-grade evidence — the measurement layer the sector is missing, delivered as software plus the field capability to make it real.

DESIGN

Indicator builder

Programme designed against named SDG targets and Vision 2030 / SGI pillars, with baselines and instruments generated before delivery starts — because afterwards is too late.

DELIVER

Field data capture

Offline-capable collection through local partners in the participant's own language, with attrition and exclusions recorded as they happen rather than reconstructed.

VERIFY

Evidence pack

Raw instruments, method notes, adjustments and reasoning, assembled so a third party can reconstruct the result without speaking to us. Formatted for disclosure and assurance.

Already written. Already published. Not yet software.

01 Scope

Establish what is true before designing anything. Closes with a written problem statement and an explicit list of what will *not* be measurable.

02 Design

A causal chain with an indicator on every link, mapped to named external targets. Nothing is procured until cost per outcome is stated.

03 Deliver

Execution through local organisations and locally recruited teams, with data captured as the work happens.

04 Measure

Baseline at intake, endline at a fixed interval, same instrument, same population. Attrition published as a number.

05 Verify

An evidence trail complete enough that a sceptical reader can disagree with our conclusion using our own data.

WHY US

Most people building this have never delivered a programme.

Proven where it is hardest

We deliver in flood-exposed districts of Pakistan — long supply chains, thin service coverage, populations on no distribution list. A measurement model that survives there transfers downwards in difficulty, not upwards.

The method is public

Five stages, standards attached to each, published in full — alongside eleven sourced analytical papers. We publish what underperformed. Nobody else in this category does.

100% women-led

In a category whose primary subjects are women and girls, that is an operational advantage before it is anything else: access, candour at follow-up, and data other teams cannot collect.

Consultancies write frameworks they have never had to execute. Implementers deliver without measuring. We are building from the only position that produces a working product — having done both.

WHAT EXISTS TODAY

Not an idea on a napkin.

11

Published analytical papers, every figure cited and linked to source

5

Stage method framework, published in full with standards attached

6

SDG targets dual-mapped to Vision 2030 and Saudi Green Initiative pillars

2

Delivery geographies: Pakistan and Saudi Arabia

The flagship programme

Maahwari — menstrual health delivered as product, education and follow-up together. Measured on school days retained per participant, sustained access at follow-up, and waste displaced modelled on *observed* reuse rather than rated product lifespan.

The research base

Our published analysis draws on a 25,305-participant study of menstrual practice in rural Sindh, the 2022 floods Post-Disaster Needs Assessment, comparative life-cycle assessment, and the Saudi third-sector and disclosure record.

TO COMPLETE BEFORE SUBMISSION — programme figures: districts, dates, participants enrolled, delivery partners, and measured results to date. Misk accepts idea and prototype stage, so this is not disqualifying; but any real number here is worth more than a page of method.

MARKET

Sized from public figures, with the assumption exposed.

	BASIS	VALUE
Sector	Saudi non-profit sector value, 2024	SAR 73bn
Addressable	If measurement and verification runs at 1–3% of programme spend	SAR 0.7–2.2bn
Adjacent	Listed companies already publishing sustainability reports	94
Beachhead	Corporates with a social mandate and no delivery or measurement capability	Entry point

The 1–3% band is our assumption, not a published figure. It is stated here so it can be argued with — which is the same standard we hold our programme numbers to.

The market is not "social impact measurement" in the abstract. It is a specific, dated obligation arriving at a specific set of organisations.

- Corporates facing sustainability disclosure with a social pillar they cannot evidence
- Non-profits inside a regulator's professionalisation agenda
- Funds and development finance institutions needing results in a defined framework
- Government entities building measurement capability to hold in-house

BUSINESS MODEL

Revenue from day one. Not a grant pipeline.

LAND

Design engagement

Fixed-scope: programme design, measurement plan, indicator mapping, cost-per-outcome model. Stands alone — the client is free to deliver it with anyone. Establishes the relationship and the standard.

EXPAND

Platform subscription

Per-programme licence for Verify: instrument builder, field capture, evidence pack generation. The recurring line, and the reason this is a venture rather than a consultancy.

DEEPEN

Delivery & verification

Full execution through local partners, or independent verification of programmes already running. Higher value, and the source of the field data that keeps the product honest.

The wedge is the design engagement: small, fixed-price, and it produces the artefact that makes the platform obviously necessary. Nobody buys measurement software until they have seen what their current numbers cannot survive.

COMPETITION

Everyone does two of the three.

WHO	DESIGN	DELIVER	VERIFY	THE GAP
Global consultancies	Yes	No	Partly	Frameworks written by people who have never had to execute them
Implementing NGOs	Partly	Yes	No	Measurement designed after delivery, so it cannot be repaired
ESG reporting software	No	No	Partly	Aggregates whatever it is given; cannot fix a missing baseline
Assurance firms	No	No	Yes	Arrive at the end, when the evidence either exists or does not
Torchbearer	Yes	Yes	Yes	Built from field delivery outwards, which is the only order that works

The defensible position is not the software. It is that the software encodes a method proven in the hardest delivery conditions we could find — and that we keep delivering, so it stays true.

Publish the problem. Sell the fix.

01 Inbound through published analysis

Eleven sourced papers on exactly the problems our buyers have. This deck's own argument is already public and already ranking.

02 The free diagnostic

Four questions applied to a prospect's existing impact report. It reliably fails, in public-facing material they have already published.

03 Land with a design engagement

Fixed price, weeks not months, and it produces the artefact that makes the platform necessary.

Why Saudi Arabia first

- A regulator publicly prioritising measurable impact, with budget behind it
- Disclosure obligations arriving on a known trajectory
- Corporates with mandate and money but no delivery capability
- Vision 2030 gives every buyer a named framework to report into — and we already map to it

Why Pakistan stays

It is the proving ground. Delivery economics there make rigorous measurement affordable at a scale where it would otherwise be a luxury, and a method that holds there holds anywhere.

THE TEN WEEKS

What we will have built by 2 January.

PHASE	WEEKS	WHAT WE DO	DELIVERABLE
Ideate	1–3	Validate the measurement gap with 25+ Saudi buyers: corporates, non-profits, funds. Test whether they will pay to fix it, and at what price.	Validated problem & pricing
Build	4–7	MVP of the indicator builder and evidence-pack generator, tested against a live Maahwari dataset rather than a synthetic one.	Working MVP
Test to sell	8–9	Run the free diagnostic with named prospects. Convert two into paid design engagements.	First paying customers
Grow	10+	MISA licensing route, Saudi entity, and a repeatable sales motion.	In-market

We are applying at exactly the right stage. The method is finished and public; the product is not built. That is what a pre-accelerator is for, and we are not pretending otherwise.

TEAM



Aimen Rafiq

Founder · Torchbearer

Torchbearer is **100% women-led** — from the founder to the field teams who run the sessions and collect the follow-up data.

In a category whose participants are women and girls, that is not a diversity statement. It is why we can collect data other organisations cannot, and why our follow-up response rates hold.

TO COMPLETE — founder biography: background, relevant experience, and why this problem. Add any co-founder or core team members: Misk states a preference for 2–3 co-founders, though solo founders are eligible.

We are not asking Misk for money.

Launchpad is zero-equity and does not fund. So here is what we actually need from the ten weeks — and what you get back.

What we need

- Access to **Saudi buyers** for problem validation — corporates with disclosure exposure and non-profits inside the NCNP agenda
- **Mentorship on productising a method** into software without losing the rigour that makes it worth anything
- **MISA support** toward an investment licence and a Saudi entity
- **Pricing and GTM pressure-testing** from people who have sold into this market

What Misk gets

- A venture aimed squarely at a **stated national priority** — the professionalisation of the third sector
- A **100% women-led** founding team in a cohort where that remains rare
- A founder who arrives with a **published, citable body of work** rather than a concept
- A company that intends to be **Saudi-domiciled and revenue-generating** inside twelve months

**The Kingdom decided
the sector should be
professional.
Somebody has to
build the evidence.**